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2026 Women's Insight Program – Global Banking – Melbourne

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Dear Sir or Madam,

“Life begins at the end of your comfort zone.” – Neale Donald Walsch

This mindset has shaped the way I approach both learning and leadership, and it is what draws me to investment banking and to UBS's Women's Insight Program.

Three months ago, I decided to teach myself machine learning, a subject that had long intimidated me, as I had often avoided complex mathematics in the past. With no background in computer science or advanced math, I started from zero, committing one hour every day to understanding the mathematics behind the models. Progress was incremental and often frustrating, and I am still far from mastery. Yet staying with problems longer than was comfortable taught me something more valuable than technical knowledge: consistency and discipline can make almost anything learnable.

That willingness to step beyond my comfort zone shaped how I approached my role at audibene, where I led a partner engagement project involving 1,200 business partners and generating over €700,000 in additional revenue. The challenge was no longer mathematical, it was understanding what motivates people and ensuring disciplined execution. Instead of being overwhelmed by the scale of the project, I approached complexity with structure. I analyzed stakeholder interests and implemented systems to strengthen relationships and secure long-term partnerships. For this project, I received the company's Global Excellence Award, becoming the first intern in its 12-year history to earn this recognition. More important than the award was the realization that impact begins the moment you choose ownership.

I carried this sense of ownership into my role as Head of Event Organization at WHU Students Help, organizing a charity concert with over 350 attendees and raising more than €6,000. Under time pressure, I learned that leadership requires clear communication and trust within a team.

A clear pattern connects these experiences: I move toward complexity rather than away from it. Investment banking represents this environment at the highest level, where structured thinking, resilience, and collaboration are essential in advising clients on critical financial decisions. UBS's Global Banking platform is where I want to further develop these capabilities.

I am eager to bring curiosity, discipline, and a strong sense of responsibility to the Women's Insight Program, and to continue moving beyond my comfort zone.

Kind regards,
Victoria Sikavica